From	Robert Samuel White
To	Director Lisa Sumption; Deputy Director JR Collier
Cc	OPRD Commissioners; Governor Kotek; [Kotek Campaign Chair]
Date	September 19, 2026, 6:29 PM PT
Subject	**Published: "The Director and Her Deputy."**
Document	01M2Y6X0GGCJYN4Q63HEM55MVM

https://oprdvolunteerabuse.org/testimony/v1.7/

The letter he put in her hands

On July 29, 2025 he was a campground host at Driftwood II, in the Siltcoos corridor of the Oregon Dunes National Recreation Area, four months after Oregon State Parks dismissed him. That afternoon he read an interview with the director, and he wrote to her. I hope you are successful at finding an ethical and supportive way to keep our state parks going. Then he told her he had been one of her volunteers from January through March, and that it had been deeply rewarding.

Then he told her the truth of what had been done to him inside her institution. He asked her for nothing. He named the staff by their positions, told her the institution was hers and the people in it were her responsibility, and told her to sit with that. He was not appealing to her. He had not been part of her hierarchy since the day he was dismissed, and he wrote to her as one person telling another what her institution had done.

He was a year into building Autonomy Realms. A person gets a realm of their own, and anything they have ever recorded goes into it as a signal: video, audio, photographs, documents, conversations, a journal page photographed off a shelf after twenty years (0:15), the route of a walk. The system does not summarise them. It reads each one through several lenses at once, what happened and what it was and what it carries and what it says about the shape of the person, and one of those lenses is a mirror that hands him his own interior back in words he did not yet have for it (1:07). That mirror is the reason the rest of it exists (1:17). Then it reads across: a hundred signals out of one stretch of time taken together (2:16), so that a season of a life has its own arc and its own reflections instead of a hundred separate entries (7:36). All of it embedded and indexed, so the record can be put a question, and so a machine reading him reads the whole pattern rather than the last thing he said (12:34). Maps of everywhere he walked with the photographs pinned to them (1:21). It runs on hardware he pays for, under rswfire.com, a domain name he has held for twenty-three years. rswfire is his name, and it has been his for the whole span of the internet.

The letter he made public

On August 3 the Forest Service gave him Tahkenitch Landing to run by himself (0:35), the campground above the lake off Highway 101 (1:53). He ran it alone and built through it. On his days off he walked to the ocean (15:55). On August 31 he took the Tahkenitch Creek trail out with a friend, three and a third miles, and stood at the water.

He waited a month. Then he published an Open Letter to her on r/volunteer. He wrote it there because private channels have been met with silence. He opened it by naming what she had built: the first woman to lead the institution, millions in infrastructure, accessibility work, president of the National Association of State Park Directors, an appointment to the National Parks Service Advisory Board. He named the manager telling him to chew glass and swallow it, the admission that he was never given the benefit of the doubt from day one, two months of pressure designed to force a resignation, and a dismissal six days before his scheduled completion. He wrote that the recordings exist and that the only question was how she would answer them. He also named the imbalance out loud: The very people who harm volunteers often have the institutional power to compound that harm through retaliation. It has literally already happened at Honeyman. Every fact he set out in that letter was later given a different account in the Timeline of Events the program manager wrote about him and handed to the police. The two documents are set side by side on sunlight.

What he asked for was not for himself. I am not asking for apologies or personal remedies. I am asking for institutional accountability that protects future volunteers from experiencing what I experienced. He listed five things: a transparent investigation of the misconduct at Honeyman, consequences for managers who use coercive tactics on volunteers, protections against retaliation for volunteers who report, a grievance process that does not depend on the good faith of the managers causing the harm, and training and oversight for volunteer supervision. He said none of it was extraordinary, and that if it happened the whole thing became a story about an institution learning something.

She answered the next afternoon. While I cannot respond here to the specific claims you have outlined, I want to assure you that I take concerns about our volunteer program seriously. The five things he asked for were concerns about the volunteer program. An investigation of the misconduct, consequences for managers who coerce volunteers, protection from retaliation for volunteers who report, a grievance process independent of the managers causing the harm, and training and oversight. She answered none of them in the message that assured him she took such concerns seriously. She did not say the claims were false and she did not say they were true, and she named no place where she could respond to them. What she did was answer a public letter warmly enough that answering it again would look like repetition. An open letter carries its weight once, and her reply had used it up. He watched her do it as he read it and took her measure. She was sophisticated. He had no move against it, so he waited for one.

Federal ground, and a system shipped

In October the Forest Service moved him again, to the Siltcoos Work Center, where he became the caretaker embedded on federal land behind a locked gate (0:38), a few miles from the park that dismissed him. It was his second advancement in five months and he is still there. He reached the ocean on foot four times that October, the longest of them seven miles down the Tahkenitch Creek trail on the twenty-third.

The public records request he had filed on August 22 was in its third month without an acknowledgment. Nobody had lost it. Her records officers had answered it to a portal he had no account for and was never told existed, and left it there. On October 13 he got the reflection

architecture running end to end and tested it by having a model read the first recording he ever made, two years earlier, from four perspectives (0:46). Overnight on the fourteenth he ran the analysis across half his catalog (1:06). At one in the morning on the twentieth the access layer was finished (0:18), standing over roughly eight hundred recordings going back to February 2024 (0:48).

November, and a thirty-two-year dependency discarded

On November 15 he served the Director and the Deputy Director notice that his request had been held for eighty-five days in violation of Oregon law (6:32). Six days later he told them an archive of the whole matter existed and what was in it (8:32). The request had been made to a public body that is required to answer (6:37), and answering it would have put the record of what they did into his hands (6:43).

That month he took his own systems off other people’s. He moved his infrastructure from Amazon onto two servers he provisioned himself (1:50), and he ended public distribution of his recordings entirely (3:08), putting them behind his own gate on hardware he controlled.

He did the same to himself. On November 4 he put down nicotine, cold, after thirty-two years of it, from the age of sixteen (6:28). He built the conditions to hold it: no fuel (18:36), no willingness to ask for help, and a life structured to stay inside the corridor so that town was not reachable. He walked instead. He had been at Siltcoos Beach on the second, the day he wrote down the statute violation, and he was back at the water on the sixth, the ninth after seven and a half miles, the tenth after twelve and a half, the eleventh, and the fifteenth. Seven times that month he walked out to the ocean and back, in rain and after dark (3:18), far enough that a step counter put him in the top three percent of everyone it tracks (5:21). On the sixth day he said it was the furthest he had made it in thirty-two years.

December, and the archive gets an address

On December 7 he wrote to tell her what he had made of the nine months since. He was two months into the caretaker post at the Siltcoos Work Center, on federal ground a few miles from the park that dismissed him. Nine months with the United States Forest Service. Promoted twice. Trusted with their work trucks and a twenty-five mile daily route. Facts. I was never the problem.

She answered at 8:37 the next morning in therapeutic language. She could see how painful this had been for him. She heard the frustration and the hurt in his words. The pain, the frustration and the hurt are her words. He had not used them. What he had put in front of her was nine months with the Forest Service, two advancements, a work truck and a twenty-five mile route, and the statement that he was never the problem. She answered a man she had assembled out of his letter, and not one sentence of it addressed a fact he had given her. Then she closed it: We’ve reached a point where I don’t believe further correspondence will lead to the resolution you’re seeking. Answering a documented complaint by describing feelings the complainant never expressed is the oldest instrument an institution has, and the program manager had already run it on him. That day he went into town and put money in the bank so he could register oprdvolunteerabuse.org. Then he answered her in one line, that he acknowledged receipt, and signed it with the domain underneath his name. The site was empty. There was nothing on it at all. The only thing that existed was the name, and it was sitting under his name in her inbox. At 8:37 that morning she had written that further correspondence would lead nowhere. At 2:48 that afternoon she wrote again, three words, the last she would ever write to him. And I yours. He laughed

out loud.

Her answer recast a documented complaint as pain and closed the only channel that reached the officer with the authority to act on it. Closing it ended nothing. It moved the matter out of her inbox and into a public archive she did not control (0:11).

The notice, and an order to stop

In January he served notice under 42 U.S.C. section 1983, and in February notice that the constitutional violation was ongoing. In the same weeks he finished the analysis layer and got the reflections working (6:25), registered the domain the platform would run under, and on the twentieth deleted both of his channels (0:23), nearly nine hundred recordings (0:32), after pulling every one of them down onto storage he controlled.

In February the Deputy Director wrote the fourth and final reply. He wrote that the agency recognised he might be filing a legal action, and that when he did, his correspondence would go to their Department of Justice counsel. Please do not communicate further with Ms. [Program Manager] or other OPRD staff, and please do not expect any responses from them. Five minutes later he answered it. He told the Deputy Director he had no authority to say who a citizen may contact inside a public agency, that his structured process was an internal matter with no bearing on what a citizen does, and that he would contact whoever he needed to contact, whenever he chose to. Don’t confuse your internal routing procedures with authority over me.

The Director and Her Deputy

The Director and the Deputy Director are the last two offices inside the institution. Everything the volunteer services lead did, and the park supervisor, and the park manager, and the program manager, ran up to those two desks and stopped there. Above them is a Commission and a Governor, and he had written to both of those as well. A director’s office exists so that a failure underneath it can be corrected. That is the whole function.

What reached them was not rumour. Named staff, dated conduct, the documents, and recordings of the meetings themselves, offered to them over and over and never once asked for.

Four replies came back. One answered a public letter without answering any of it. One closed the correspondence. One was three words. One barred him from the staff and told him to expect nothing from them. Not one asked him a question, requested a document, or named a person who would look at any of it. Neither of them opened an inquiry. Neither referred it anywhere. Neither gave a reason. The records law obliged them to answer and they let it run eighty-five days past.

He spent those same seven months building. He put the reflection engine together and ran his whole catalogue through it (1:31), moved his infrastructure onto servers he owns, took his life off every platform that held it (2:42), set down thirty-two years of nicotine (3:13), and walked to the ocean and back in the rain through all of it. On May 18 he walked from the RV down the Siltcoos River to the water and said the thing was finished (5:18), robust, and ready for other people to use.

The only operational decision either of them made in all of it was the order closing the agency to him. Eighteen days after it, an emergency manager inside the institution took his letters to a captain of the Oregon State Police. The Deputy Director was copied on it.

From	Robert Samuel White
To	Director Lisa Sumption; Deputy Director JR Collier
Cc	OPRD Commissioners; Governor Kotek; [Kotek Campaign Chair]
Date	September 19, 2026, 7:21 PM PT
Subject	**Re: Published: "The Director and Her Deputy."**
Document	01M2Y9VYK85ZEJMRTSF87PMPWB

I am noting an error here:

"On November 15 he served the Director and the Deputy Director notice that his request had been held for eighty-five days in violation of Oregon law (6:32)."

I did not yet have any correspondence with the Deputy at this point. His role will be removed from this sentence and reflected correctly in v1.8:

https://oprdvolunteerabuse.org/testimony/v1.8/#c11

v1.8 also removes a redundant chapter on what I built since it is incorporated into the chapter on the director and the deputy. This changes the chapter numbers, which you can see reflected in the link above.

Robert Samuel White